

Curriculum Vitae

Personal Details:

Full Name: Desai Shaileshkumar Dhudabhai
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Academic Background:

CSIR JRF NET All Indian Rank 37 (September 2022)
GSET (2022)

PHD Scholar: 1 January 2023. Currently I am working as research scholar with Prof. Gyaneshwer Chaubey, and we are trying to understand the different aspect of agriculture origin in Indian subcontinent.

2018- 2020 **M.Sc. Zoology,**
Distinction with (**Percentage 78%**)
Department of Life Sciences, HNG University, Patan.

Dissertation Topic- “Evaluation and assessment of Human- wildlife conflict special reference to crop damage in the arid landscape of Gujarat”

2015-2018 **B.Sc. Zoology,** Distinction with (**Percentage 81%**)
Sheth M.N science college, Patan
HNG University, Patan Gujarat, India.

Research Interest

Since my elementary school level, I was very curious about how DNA store and transfer information, encoded via just combination of codon, and I always wonder the complexity of DNA. In my college level I was used here or view documentary regarding origin of modern human, their migration and ancient civilization and origin of agricultures (Plants and Animal). Since my interest was on utilizing the DNA to trace the Migration, ancient society/civilization, admixture and origin of agriculture, I started my PhD in Population genetics, in January, 2023. I am very much interested in understanding, how human migrated, colonized and mixed with different populations as well as how they started domestication of plants and animal, which ultimately help them to live sedentary lifestyle rather than hunter gather. It is very intriguing to study, how domesticated animal moved across different place, which also help in tracing historical human migration as well as cultural activity. Currently I am focusing to understand how and when different domestic animal (Pigs, Dogs, Chickens, Buffaloes, Cows) brought to Indian subcontinent or domesticated independently. In future, I am interested in studying consequence of domestication in domesticated animal gene pool, selection as well as introgression (Domestic to wild, vice-versa), and studying their evolutionary landscape in spatial and temporal context utilizing both Modern and Ancient Samples.

Experience: I am well verse in handling and doing analysis of large-scale genomic data using HPC system and capable of writing script in Python. I have experience of handling data from raw reads (fastq) to VCF and doing different population level analysis as well as equipped with handling aDNA data.

Publication:

Desai, S., Adhikary, V., Bhattacharyya, M., Tharu, M. K., Sharma, A., Sequeira, J. J., Pandey, R. K., Pandey, P., Shendre, S. S., Tayyeh, A. M., S, S. L., Mustak, M. S., Petraglia, M., & Chaubey, G. (2026). South Asian maternal lineage haplogroup R30 provides phylogenetic evidence of human dispersal across South Asia [Preprint]. bioRxiv. <https://doi.org/10.64898/2026.04.29.721543>.

Welikala, A., **Desai, S.,** Fernando, A., Kotelawala, J., Jayasekara, L., Singh, P. P., Jayasoma, A., Aragon, J. A. U., Witonsky, D., Rai, N., Thangaraj, K., Raghavan, M., Adikari, G., Tennekoon, K. H., Chaubey, G., & Ranasinghe, R. (2026). Sri Lankan maternal ancestry reveals early migrations from Africa along the Indian Ocean. PLOS ONE, 21(5), e0350045. <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0350045>. **(Equally contributed)**

Acharya, S., Kushwaha, P., **Desai, S.,** Biswas, S., Longjam, L. A., Chatterjee, B., Ruwali, M., De, S., Krishnaswamy, L., Suravajhala, P., & Chaubey, G. (2026). Draft genome sequencing of *Proteus mirabilis* strain Indica (ST286) reveals antimicrobial resistance and virulence determinants. BMC microbiology, 10.1186/s12866-026-05127-z. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12866-026-05127-z>.

Singh, V., Basu Mallick, C., Chatterjee, M., Tamang, R., **Desai, S.,** Singh, P. P., Mishra, R. K., Pandey, R. K., Mishra, R., Singh, A., Suravajhala, P., Bandyopadhyay, A. R., & Chaubey, G. (2026). Admixture and Genetic Connectivity: Autosomal Insights Into Indo-Aryan Speakers at the Eastern Edge of the Indian Subcontinent. American journal of human biology : the official journal of the Human Biology Council, 38(3), e70245. <https://doi.org/10.1002/ajhb.70245>.

Pandey, R. K., Vandana, **Desai, S.,** Suravajhala, P., & Chaubey, G. (2026). Cycle Threshold (Ct) Value Trends in COVID-19: Analyzing Gender, Age, and Severity Factors Across Major Waves in India. Immunity, inflammation and disease, 14(2), e70304. <https://doi.org/10.1002/iid3.70304>.

Desai, S., Alqaisi, M. H. M., Singh, P. P., Pandey, P., Pandey, R. K., Mishra, R. K., Das, D., Roy, A., Bhutra, S., Gamboa, A., Rai, S. K., Rapheal, J. T., Tiwary, S. K., Baraka, G., Patel, B., & Chaubey, G. (2026). Maternal Genetic Ancestry of Gujarat: A Pleistocene Passage to India. American journal of biological anthropology, 189(1), e70193. <https://doi.org/10.1002/ajpa.70193>.

Pandey, R. K., **Desai, S.,** & Chaubey, G. (2025). Neanderthal introgressed COVID-19 risk locus 3p21.31 under positive selection in East Asia via LZTFL1-driven ciliary changes. bioRxiv. <https://doi.org/10.1101/2025.10.01.679818>.

Das, D., Singh, P. P., **Desai, S.,** Mishra, R. K., Shrivastava, P., Suravajhala, P., Tamang, R., & Chaubey, G. (2025). Outlier maternal haplogroups N5 and X2 and their potential role in elevated tuberculosis prevalence among the Sahariya tribe. Mitochondrion, 85, 102078. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.mito.2025.102078>.

Grilo, C., Neves, T., Bates, J. **Desai, S.**, ..., et al. Global Roadkill Data: a dataset on terrestrial vertebrate mortality caused by collision with vehicles. *Scientific Data* 12, 505 (2025). <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41597-024-04207-x>. (Part of Global data collection Consortium).

Singh, Prajval Pratap., Pathak, Ajai Kumar., Tiwary, Sachin kr., **Desai, Shailesh.**, Mishra, Rahul Kumar., Tamang, Rakesh., Shinde, Vasant., VILLEMS, Richards., Kivisild, Toomas., Metspalu, Mait., ..., Chaubey, Gyaneshwer. Brahui and Oraon: Tracing the Northern Dravidian genetics link in Balochistan. *Human population genetics and Genomics*. 2025; 5(1):0003. <https://doi.org/10.47248/hpgg2505010003>.

Desai, Shailesh., Singh, Prajval P., Pandey, Rudra Kumar., Mishra, Rahul Kumar., Chaubey, Akhilesh Kumar., Kumar, Ajit., Tiwary, Sachin kr., Gupta, Sandeep., Achilli, Alessandro., Migliore, Nicola Rambaldi., Cahubey, Gyaneshwer. Multiple Domestication centers of the Indian pig populations. *Genome Biology and Evolution*, Volume 17, Issue 3, March 2025, evaf030, <https://doi.org/10.1093/gbe/evaf030>.

Kumar, V., Sharma, G., Sharma, S., Prasad, S., **Desai, S.**, Vaishnani, T., Vishnudasan, D., Maheswaran, G., Tyagi, K., Tyagi, I., Kavi Kishor, P. B., Chaubey, G., & Suravajhala, P. (2025). Whole genome sequencing and assembly of the house sparrow, *Passer domesticus*. *GigaByte* (Hong Kong, China), 2025, gigabyte161. <https://doi.org/10.46471/gigabyte.161>.

Mishra, Rahul Kumar., Singh, Prajval Pratap., Rai, Niraj., **Desai, Shailesh.**, Pandey Pratik., Tiwary, Sachin Kr., Tamang, Rakesh., Suravajhala, Prashanth., Thangaraj, Kumarasamy., Van Driem, George., and Chaubey, Gyaneshwer. Reconstructing the population history of the Nicobarese. *European Journal Human Genetics* (2024). <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41431-024-01720-w>.

Welikala A, **Desai S**, Pratap Singh P, Fernando A, Thangaraj K, van Driem G, Adikari G, Tennekoon K, Chaubey G, Ranasinghe R. The genetic identity of the Vedda: A language isolate of South Asia. *Mitochondrion*. 2024 Apr 16;76:101884. doi: 10.1016/j.mito.2024.101884. **(Equally contributed)**

Jani V., **Desai S.**, Sabapara S & Gosai C (2023). Aerial symphony at water dam: An annotated checklist of bird diversity of baliyaad dam, Junagadh, Gujarat, India. *Munis entomology and Zoology*, 18(48):2046-2054.

Desai S., Gosai, C & Chaubey, G (2023). Preliminary Status and Distribution of Indian Grey Wolf (*Canis lupus pallipes*) in the Bhal Region of Gujarat. *International Journal of Ecology and Environmental Sciences* 49, 2023.

Desai, S., Gosai, C, & Dharaiya, N. (2022). Notes on jungle cat (*F. Chaus*) nesting sites in agricultural areas and associated threat. *IUCN Cat News*, 76, 34-35.

Desai, S., (2022). Road network is a death trap for wildlife – a note on the roadkill of small Indian civet (*Viverricula indica*) from Banaskatha district of Gujarat, India. *Scientific Reports in Life Sciences*, 3(1), 54–60. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.6512899>.

Desai S., Thacker D. and Gosai C. (2021). Threat to Red-wattled Lapwing persistence –A short note on interaction between Red-wattled Lapwing (*Vanellus indicus*) and domestic dog (*Canis familiaris*) in agricultural areas. *Prithivya, an Official Newsletter of WCB Research Foundation and WCB Research Lab*. Vol 1(3) 6-9.

Desai, S., Talluri, H., & Dharaiya, N. (2021). An assessment of farmers' attitudes towards crop damage by wildlife and its prevention methods in the arid landscape of Gujarat. *Uttar Pradesh Journal of Zoology*, 42(21), 52-60.

Master Dissertation report:

Evaluation and assessment of Human-wildlife conflict with special reference to crop damage in arid landscape of Gujarat submitted to the department of life sciences, HNG University, Patan, and Gujarat, India.

Conference/ Award /workshop/training

- Participated “Temporal Genomics workshop (aDNA) organized by NCBS and IISC Bangalore (9th – 12th May, 2026).
- Visited PalaeoBarn, School of Archaeology, University of Oxford, UK for Five Month as Visiting student, Sponsored by Banaras Hindu University, Varanasi, India (1st Oct, 2025, to 28th Feb, 2026).
- Received Travel Grant from SERB to attend **summer course in analysis of high throughput data for population genetic, 2024** (19-23 August, 2024) at University of Copenhagen, Denmark.
- Attended the **summer course in analysis of high throughput data for population genetic, 2024** (19-23 August, 2024) at University of Copenhagen, Denmark.
- Attended sixth Bangalore school on **Population genetics and Evolution**, 12 February to 23 February 2024 organized by the international center for theoretical sciences (ITCS-TIFR).
- Attended and poster presentation on **domestication of pig in India, at SMBE Regional meetings India** (Molecular mechanisms in Evolution), Dehradun, India, 16-17 December 2023.
- Attended online **Tartu winter school on Evolution, Genomic and Medicine**, 4-8 December 2023, organized by Tartu University, Estonia.
- Attended the “**Statistical Genomics 2023**” from 16 August to 19 August 2023 jointly organized by NCBS Bangalore, IISC Bangalore, and Aarhus University, Denmark at NCBS, Bangalore, India.
- Participated and organized 23rd Annual convention on Translating human evolutionary history to precision medicine, from 10 March to 12 March 2023, hosted by Department of Zoology, Banaras Hindu University, Varanasi, and Uttar Pradesh, India.
- Hands on training program on “**Capillary sequencing & fragment analysis**” as a part of **KAUSHALYA** jointly organized by Gujarat biotechnology research Centre and national forensic Sciences University, Gandhinagar held during 14th – 18th November 2022.
- UGC STRIDE skill development Programme on “**Biodiversity – from concept to conservation** (22nd -31st March 2021) organized by the Madurai Kamaraj University, Tamil Nadu.
- A Weeklong national training Programme on **research techniques in wildlife & habitat** (8- 12, January 2021) was organized by the WCB research foundation, Patan.
- Two-day international virtual conference on “**wildlife forensics, its law, and conservation**”

organized by the Department of forensics science and criminal investigation (India), Galgotias University, and wildlife conservation trust on July 28-29, 2020.

- Workshop on “**Technique in field biology**” organized by Department of Zoology K.J Somaiya College of sci & comm and Hemchandracharya North Gujarat University on 30th to 31 May 2020.
- Two-week long training on GIS Mapping organized by the Hemchandracharya North Gujarat University, Patan, 2020.
- Participate in **Flamingo census – DEC- 2019** organized by the State Forest department.
- One-day wetland seminar & a weeklong Training workshop on “**Studying cranes, their habitats and food-web components**” in Gujarat organized by GEER FOUNDATION – 2019.
- Paper presented in a webinar on **biodiversity, wildlife, and traditional knowledge from 8th to 9th May 2020** organized by ENVIS-RP, Institute of Wildlife Sciences, ONGC Centre for Advanced Studies, University of Lucknow, Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh.
- Participate in National level conference (**AVISKAR-20**) organized by HNG University and ABVP, Patan, Gujarat, India.
- Poster presentation on *Homo Naledi* – **A new hominin species**, in **SCIENCE EXCELLENCE-2018** organized by the Gujarat University, Ahmadabad, Gujarat, India.

References:

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